
Inventory Management System User Manual

How to ask for things, approve them, and keep the store straight.

Who this is for. Everyone who uses the system. It is written in plain language and assumes you have never seen the system before.

How to read it. Part 1 is for everybody — read that first. Then read only the part for your own job. You do not need to read the whole book.

Southern IoT · Internal system · Amounts in BDT · Times shown in Asia/Dhaka
Manual version 1.0

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Four parts, then three short reference lists at the back.

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REFERENCE

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The whole journey on one page

Almost everything in this system is one of two journeys. This is the longer one — buying something new. Borrowing is much shorter and is covered in section 6.

- | | | |
|----------|--|-------------------|
| 1 | Someone asks
Fills in a requisition: what, how many, roughly how much, and why. | Anybody |
| 2 | The Inventory Manager reviews it
First pair of eyes. Checks it is sensible and not already in the store. | Inventory Manager |
| 3 | One or two approvers sign off
How many depends on the amount. See section 13. | Approvers |
| 4 | A Bill of Materials is made
Approved requests are grouped into one document Accounts can pay against. | Inventory Manager |
| 5 | It goes to Accounts, and money comes back
The money received is recorded against the request. | Inventory Manager |
| 6 | The buying happens, and is checked
Vendor, invoice and real prices are recorded, then verified. | Inventory Manager |
| 7 | The goods go on the shelf
Stock goes up. From here the item can be borrowed by anybody. | Inventory Manager |

ONE RULE WORTH KNOWING EARLY

Nothing in this system is deleted. A mistake is corrected by recording the correction, so the history always shows what really happened and who did it.

For everybody

Read this part whoever you are. It covers signing in, the bell, looking things up, borrowing, and asking to buy something.

1 Signing in

Open the address your administrator gave you. You will see a sign-in box.

- 1 Type your **"Email"** — the work address your administrator used when they made your account.
- 2 Type your **"Password"**.
- 3 Press .

You land on your dashboard. The system remembers you on that computer, so you will not have to sign in every time.

IF YOU WERE GIVEN A TEMPORARY PASSWORD

The system will ask you to choose your own before it lets you do anything else. Pick something only you know. Nobody in the office — including the administrator — needs to know your password.

IF IT SAYS TOO MANY ATTEMPTS

Signing in wrongly several times in a row locks the door for about a minute. That is deliberate. Wait a minute and try again — nothing is broken and your account is not blocked.

2 Finding your way around the screen

Every page has the same three things.

- **The menu, down the left.** Everything you are allowed to do is in there. If you cannot see a menu item, your role does not include it — that is normal, not a fault.
- **The bell, top right.** Your news. A red number means you have unread items.
- **Your name, top right corner.** Your account, and the way out. Signing out is in there.

Everyone sees **"Dashboard"**, **"Inventory"**, **"My borrowings"**, **"My requisitions"** and **"Projects"**. Anything below that depends on your role.

3 Notifications — the bell

The system tells you when something you care about moves: your request was approved or rejected, a borrow you asked for was allowed, a BOM was made. Press the bell to read them.

- The number on the bell is how many you have not read. It shows **9+** once there are more than nine.
- **Mark all as read** clears the number.
- **Unread only** hides the ones you have already seen.

THE BELL IS THE ONLY PLACE

The system does not send emails or SMS. If you are waiting on something, the bell is where it will appear.

4 Your dashboard

The first page after signing in. It shows who you are signed in as, then **Your record** — and only you can see that.

- **Requisitions** — how many you have raised, how many are still going on, and how many finished.
- **Borrowing** — how many items you have taken, how many are still with you, and what condition things came back in.
- **Money** — what you asked for, what was approved, and what has actually been paid out on your requests.

5 Looking up an item in the store

Open “Inventory” from the menu. This is the stock register: every movement in and out is recorded and cannot be edited afterwards.

- 1 Type part of the name in “Search”, or pick a “Category”.
- 2 Tick “In stock only” to hide things that are finished.
- 3 Click any row to open that item.

On the item's own page you can see which shelves it sits on, what is currently out with people, and its recent movements.

The numbers on the list, in plain words

COLUMN	WHAT IT MEANS
Total owned	Everything the company has, including what is out with people.
In project use	Out with somebody right now for a project.
Available	What you could actually take today. This is the number that matters.

6 Borrowing something

Borrowing is for something the company already owns. If the store does not have it, you want section 8 instead.

- 1 Find the item in “**Inventory**” and open it.
- 2 Press **Borrow**.
- 3 Fill in the form:
 - “**From**” — which shelf it should come off.
 - “**Quantity**” — how many you need.
 - “**Project**” — if it is for a project, choose it.
 - “**I will return this**” — leave it ticked for a tool or a laptop. Untick it for something that gets used up and never comes back, like cable or tape.
 - “**Expected back**” — the day you will return it.
 - “**Purpose**” — what it is for. This helps the Inventory Manager say yes quickly.
- 4 Press **Borrow** to send the request.

The Inventory Manager reviews it. Watch the bell. You can follow it under “**My borrowings**”, where the filters mean:

- **Pending** — waiting for the Inventory Manager.
- **Out** — approved, and with you now.
- **Returned** — given back.
- **Overdue** — past the day you said you would return it.

7 Giving it back

Take the item to the Inventory Manager. They record the return in the system, and note what condition it came back in. You do not do this yourself — that way there is always a second person who saw the item.

YOU CAN RETURN PART OF IT

Borrowed five and only finished with three? The Inventory Manager can record three back; the other two stay out in your name.

8 Asking to buy something

This is a **requisition**. Use it when the company does not have the thing, or has run out. Open “**My requisitions**” and press **New requisition**.

Part one — the request itself

- 1 “**Department**” — whose budget this comes out of.

- 2 “Project” — if it belongs to one.
- 3 “Urgency” — Low, Normal, High or Critical. Be honest; marking everything Critical stops it meaning anything.
- 4 “Approval deadline” — the date you need it decided by. Press **Select date & time**, choose the day, then **Set deadline**. You must fill this in.
- 5 “Reason” — why you need it. Your approver reads this and very little else. A good reason is the difference between approved today and questions tomorrow.
- 6 “Supporting document” — optional. A quotation or a specification sheet, if you have one.

Part two — the things you want

- 1 Type what you need, how many, and the price for one. The system works out the line total.
- 2 Press **Add item** for each further thing.
- 3 “Transportation cost” — optional. Fuel, vehicle hire, a porter. It is added to the total you are asking for.

Part three — send it

- **Submit for approval** — sends it. The Inventory Manager sees it straight away.
- **Save draft** — keeps it private. Nobody is told, and nothing happens until you come back and submit it.

ONCE YOU SUBMIT, THE FIGURES ARE FIXED

The amounts and the list of approvers are locked at the moment you press **Submit for approval**. If you got something wrong, cancel the request and raise a new one — do not ask someone to change it later.

9 Following your request

Open “My requisitions” and click the row. Two things on that page tell you everything.

- **Progress** — the people who have to sign, in order, and which one it is sitting with right now.
- **Lifecycle** — the longer journey: Submitted, IM review, Approved, BOM, Accounts, Funded, Purchased, Verified, In stock.

While it is still early you can press **Cancel request** to stop it. Appendix A explains every status word you might see.

IF IT IS REJECTED

The person who rejected it must write a reason, and you will see that reason on the request. Read it, fix the problem, and raise a new one.

10 Your account and your password

Press your name in the top right corner, then your account. You will find your details, and a link to change your password. Approvers and the Inventory Manager also have a signature panel there — see section 13.

For approvers

You decide whether the company spends the money. Everything in Part 1 applies to you as well — you can borrow and raise requests like anybody else.

11 What lands in your queue

Open “Approvals” from the menu. It opens on **Waiting on me** — the requests where it is your turn. The other tabs are **All**, **Approved** and **Rejected**, so you can look back at what you decided.

Each row shows the reference, who raised it, how much, the urgency, and the date they need a decision by. Click a row to open it.

SORT YOUR DAY BY THE DEADLINE COLUMN

Every request carries the date the requester needs an answer by. That column, not the urgency word, is the one to work through.

12 Reading a request properly

Four things are worth your attention before you decide.

- **Reason.** Why they say they need it.
- **Line items.** What, how many, and the price they expect to pay for one.
- **Requested / Approved amount.** The totals, including transportation.
- **Progress.** Who has already signed, and who comes after you.

If a supporting document was attached, it is on the same page.

13 Approving or rejecting

Scroll to **Your decision**. You have three buttons.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Approve without signature	Approves it and passes it to the next person in the chain.
Approve with signature	The same, but stamps your saved signature onto the paperwork. Use this where a signed document is expected.
Reject	Stops the request dead. You must write a note saying why.

YOUR SIGNATURE

To use **Approve with signature** you must upload your signature once, on your account page. Until you do, only the plain approve button will work.

REJECTING ENDS IT FOR EVERYONE

One rejection stops the whole request — the later approvers never see it. Your note is the only thing the requester has to work from, so write a sentence they can act on, not just “no”.

How many approvers are needed

It depends on the amount, against a threshold your administrator sets (15,000 to begin with).

- **Below the threshold** — the Inventory Manager, then one approver.
- **At or above it** — the Inventory Manager, then two approvers.

The request itself tells you which applies: it says how many approvers are required and what the threshold was on the day it was submitted. Changing the threshold later never disturbs a request already in flight.

YOU NEVER APPROVE YOUR OWN REQUEST

If you raise a requisition yourself, the system leaves your own step out of the chain rather than asking you to sign your own paperwork.

14 The expenses page

“Expenses” in the menu is the money view across the whole company, not just your own requests. It shows:

- **The four stages of money** — what was approved, what Accounts actually funded, what has been spent, and what is still outstanding.
- **Money Return and Money in Hand** — money given back to Accounts, and money still sitting with whoever went to buy.
- **A month-by-month ledger**, a twelve-month trend, and the items the company spends most on.

For the Inventory Manager

You are the busiest person in this system. You control the shelves, you are the first reviewer on every purchase, and you record everything that happens to the money.

15 Your job, in one page

WHERE	WHAT YOU DO THERE
"Borrowing"	Approve or refuse requests to take stock out, and record it when it comes back.
"Approvals"	Your review — the first sign-off on every requisition.
"All requisitions"	Every request in the company, at whatever stage.
"Bills of Materials"	Group approved requests into one document Accounts can pay against.
"Categories" and "Locations"	How the store is organised.
"Inventory"	Add products, and correct stock counts.

16 Borrow requests

Open "Borrowing". The filters are **Pending** , **Out** , **Returned** and **Overdue** .

- 1 Work through **Pending** first — somebody is waiting.
- 2 Open a request and read the "Purpose" and the quantity.
- 3 Press **Approve** to allow it, or **Reject** if it should not go out.

Approving both allows it and issues it — the stock leaves the shelf at that moment. Rejecting releases the quantity that was being held for them.

OVERDUE IS YOUR LIST, NOT THEIRS

Nobody is chased automatically. **Overdue** is the list of items past their return date, and following them up is part of the job.

17 Taking items back in

- 1 Find the borrow — **Out** or **Overdue** .

- 2 Press **Record return**.
- 3 Enter how many are coming back. It can be fewer than were taken; the rest stay out.
- 4 Choose the “Return condition”:
 - **Good** — back on the shelf, ready for the next person.
 - **Partially damaged but usable** — still usable, but marked.
 - **Damaged / Not working** — recorded so nobody is handed a broken tool later.

Be truthful about condition. It is the only record of how the equipment is holding up.

18 Reviewing requisitions

Every requisition reaches you before it reaches any approver. You are there to catch the things an approver cannot see from a desk.

- Is it **already in the store**? Then it should be a borrow, not a purchase.
- Are the **quantities and prices sensible** for what is being asked?
- Is the **reason** clear enough for an approver to act on?

Then approve or reject it exactly as described in section 13.

19 Making a Bill of Materials

Once every approver has signed, the request is **Approved** and waiting for you to turn it into something Accounts can pay against.

- 1 Open “Bills of Materials” and press **New BOM**.
- 2 Tick the approved requisitions you want on one document. You can batch several together.
- 3 Their lines appear below. Fill in the “unit cost” and the “vendor” for each.
- 4 Press **Generate BOM**.

The system produces a numbered PDF for Accounts. It prints on plain A4 paper.

A BOM CANNOT EXCEED WHAT WAS APPROVED

If your costs add up to more than the approved amount for a requisition — carriage included — the system refuses to generate it. Lower a cost, or send the request back for a fresh decision. It will not quietly let the company commit more than it agreed to.

20 The money trail, step by step

Open the requisition and scroll to **Money and purchasing**. Each step unlocks the next.

1 Send to Accounts

Records that the BOM has left your desk. Nothing is emailed — you still hand it over the normal way.

2 Record money received

When Accounts releases the money, enter the amount, the date, and a reference — a cheque number or a transfer id.

3 Record a purchase

After buying: vendor, invoice number, date, and what each line actually cost. Attach the invoice here.

4 Verify purchase

Confirms the paperwork matches what arrived.

5 Add to inventory

Puts the goods on a shelf. Stock goes up and anyone can borrow it from this point.

The figures in that panel

FIGURE	WHAT IT MEANS
Approved	What the approvers agreed to.
Funded	What Accounts has actually handed over.
Spent	What has been paid to vendors so far.
Transportation	What the carriage really cost, on the purchase that paid it.
Returned to Accounts	Money handed back.
Unspent	Money still in hand. This should end at zero — either spent or returned.

Underneath, **What happened** lists every money event in order, with the date, who did it, and any note that was written at the time.

ACCOUNTS PAYS THE WHOLE AMOUNT IN ONE GO

In this release the system does not accept part-payments against a requisition. Record the full outstanding amount when it arrives. Paying in instalments is planned for a later version.

YOU CANNOT SPEND MORE THAN HAS BEEN FUNDED

If a purchase would commit more than the money actually received, the system refuses and tells you the two figures. Lower a unit cost, or record the rest of the funding first.

21 Undoing a step

People make mistakes, so most steps have a way back. Each one asks you to say why, and the reason is kept on the record.

BUTTON	TAKES YOU BACK TO
Back to BOM	Before it was sent to Accounts. Only while no money has been received.
Undo money received	Cancels a receipt. Only while nothing has been bought against it.
Undo purchase	Cancels a purchase, and the carriage recorded with it.
Back to purchased	Un-verifies a purchase you verified too soon.

ADDING TO INVENTORY IS THE POINT OF NO RETURN

Once goods are on the shelf, that cannot be undone from this panel — the stock record is permanent. If something is wrong after that, correct it with a stock adjustment, which leaves its own trail.

22 Categories and storage places

“Categories” group products so people can find them. “Locations” describe where things physically are — a zone, and the compartments inside it.

When you put something on a shelf you choose the zone first, then the compartment inside that zone. Keep the names the way the store is actually labelled; a compartment name nobody recognises is worse than no name at all.

For the administrator

You set the rules everyone else works inside, and you are the only person who can see the audit log.

23 People and their roles

“Users” under Admin. Create a person, give them a role, reset a password, or deactivate someone who has left.

ROLE	WHAT IT ALLOWS
General	Borrow, raise requisitions, follow their own. Everybody has this.
Approver	Everything above, plus the approvals queue and the expenses page.
Inventory Manager	Everything above, plus the store, borrowing, BOMs and the money trail.
Administrator	Everything, plus users, departments, settings and the audit log.

Roles add up rather than replace each other — an approver is a general user with approval rights on top. One person can hold several.

DEACTIVATE, DO NOT DELETE

When somebody leaves, deactivate the account. Their name still has to appear correctly on every approval and every stock movement they were part of.

24 Departments

Departments are whose budget a requisition comes out of, and they appear in the expenses reporting. Every person should belong to one.

25 Settings

Business rules that take effect immediately, with no redeploy and no developer.

SETTING	WHAT IT CONTROLS
Expense threshold	The amount at or above which a requisition needs the larger number of approvers.
Approvers below the threshold Approvers at or above the threshold	How many approvers each size of request needs.
Approver slots	Which people fill Approver 1 and Approver 2. Only someone with the Approver role can be put in a slot.
Sub-threshold approver	Who approves everything below the threshold. Must be set , or small requisitions cannot be submitted at all.
Audit actions	Which actions the audit log records. Some can never be switched off.
Audit history retention	How long audit history is kept, from five days to forever.

A DEPARTMENT CAN HAVE ITS OWN APPROVERS

The approver slots you set here are the company default. A department can be given its own Approver 1 and Approver 2, and those win for requisitions raised against it.

CHANGING A RULE NEVER REWRITES THE PAST

Each requisition remembers the threshold and the approver list from the day it was submitted. Raise the threshold this afternoon and everything already in flight carries on under the old rule.

26 The audit log

“Audit log” records who did what and when. Sign-ins, user changes and settings changes are always recorded and cannot be switched off — an administrator who could hide their own actions would defeat the point of having a log.

27 Setting up a brand new system

A fresh installation will not accept a single requisition until these are done. Each is quick; forgetting one produces a confusing error for somebody else.

- 1 Create at least one **department**.
- 2 Create the **people**, and give them their roles.
- 3 Appoint an **Inventory Manager** — nothing moves without one.
- 4 Set **Approver 1** and **Approver 2**.
- 5 Set the **sub-threshold approver**. This is the one most often missed.
- 6 Check the **expense threshold** is the figure your office actually uses.

BEFORE THE SYSTEM HOLDS ANYTHING REAL

If the sign-in page lists demo accounts and a shared password, the system is in demonstration mode and anyone who can reach the page can sign in as anyone. That is fine while you are testing and unacceptable once there is real data. Ask whoever installed it to turn demonstration mode off before you go live.

Three short lists

Status words, who can do what, and the problems people hit in the first week.

A What each status word means

Requisitions

STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS
Draft	Saved but not sent. Only you can see it.
With the Inventory Manager	Waiting for the first review.
Awaiting approval	With one of the approvers now.
Approved	Everyone has signed. Waiting to be put on a BOM.
Rejected	Refused. The reason is on the request.
BOM generated	On a document for Accounts.
Sent to Accounts	With Accounts, waiting for money.
Funded	The money has been received.
Purchased	Bought, invoice recorded.
Purchase verified	Checked against the paperwork.
Stocked	On the shelf. Finished.
Cancelled	Stopped by the person who raised it.

Borrowing

STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS
Pending	Waiting for the Inventory Manager.
Out	Approved and with the borrower.
Returned	Back on the shelf.
Overdue	Past the promised return date.

B Who is allowed to do what

TASK	GENERAL	APPROVER	INV. MGR	ADMIN
Look up stock	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Ask to borrow	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Raise a requisition	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Approve a requisition	—	Yes	Yes	Yes
See company expenses	—	Yes	Yes	Yes
Approve a borrow, record a return	—	—	Yes	Yes
Make a BOM, record money	—	—	Yes	Yes
Add products, adjust stock	—	—	Yes	Yes
Manage users and settings	—	—	—	Yes
Read the audit log	—	—	—	Yes

C Common problems

“I cannot see a menu item somebody else has.”

Your role does not include it. Ask the administrator if you should have it.

“It will not let me submit my requisition.”

Something required is empty. The most commonly missed one is the approval deadline — the date field with the Select date & time button. Every field marked with a star must be filled.

“My request has not moved for days.”

Open it and look at **Progress**. It names the exact person it is sitting with. Go and ask them — the system does not chase anybody.

“I was signed out.”

Sign in again. If it refuses right after several wrong attempts, wait a minute — that is the lock-out, and it clears by itself.

“The available number looks wrong.”

Available excludes what is already out with people and anything set aside. Open the item and look at **Currently in use** — that usually explains the difference.

“I recorded something on the wrong request.”

Tell the Inventory Manager. Most money steps can be undone with a written reason (section 21). Nothing is deleted; the correction is recorded alongside the mistake.

STILL STUCK?

Note the reference number on the screen — something like REQ-000004-GINA or BR-000001 — and give that to whoever helps you. It identifies the exact record straight away.